

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Talking at the Table

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 9

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - Family meals

No.	Sentence
1	For one family, eating together was often the _____ when everyone could meet and chat.
2	Eating with close family members brought a sense of _____.
3	In a different group, someone known as the funny one may instead become the _____.
4	In the past, children were sometimes seated at a _____ from adults.
5	One mother's children were not brought up being _____ from adults at meals.

11 What does the family-meal example suggest about the children?

- A They find it easier to discuss their day and concerns while eating.
- B They usually save their questions until the meal has finished.
- C They prefer to discuss difficult matters with people outside the family.
- D They talk most freely when the family follows a formal routine.

12 What does the example of moving to another group suggest about family roles?

- A A person's role depends mainly on how long the group has known them.
- B A person should adopt the same role in every group they join.
- C A person's usual family label may not describe them in every group.
- D A person needs another group to discover their true family role.

13 How does this mother's approach differ from the older dinner-table arrangements described?

- A It gives children a separate space to discuss their own concerns.
- B It makes age the basis for deciding who may join a discussion.
- C It leaves adults to raise difficult subjects on the children's behalf.
- D It lets children ask questions across the former adult-child divide.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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14 **What can be inferred about the older generation's response to the children's questions?**

- A They oppose the children's questions despite enjoying family meals.
- B They are largely favourable, although the freedom to ask is unfamiliar.
- C They feel comfortable because the children follow old table rules.
- D They approve only when the children sit at a separate table.